

FPFK KERICHO TOWN CHURCH

SERMON SERIES

GOD'S ROAD TO FINANCIAL FREEDOM

Seven Sermons from Billy Epperhart's God's Road to Financial Freedom

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Key Text: Deuteronomy 8:18

SERIES OVERVIEW

This seven-sermon series is drawn from Billy Epperhart's book *God's Road to Financial Freedom*. Each message builds on the previous, moving the congregation from a Kingdom theology of wealth through practical steps of debt elimination, wealth building, and generous stewardship — all anchored in the covenant promise of Deuteronomy 8:18.

- Sermon 1 — The Power to Get Wealth (Introduction)
- Sermon 2 — The Big Picture: The Triple-X Factor (Chapter 1)
- Sermon 3 — Moving from Manna to Promised Land (Chapter 2)
- Sermon 4 — Seven Steps Toward Freedom (Chapter 3)
- Sermon 5 — Mastering Your Earned Income (Chapter 4)
- Sermon 6 — Nine Steps to Destroy Debt (Chapter 5)
- Sermon 7 — Building Wealth & Giving It Away (Chapters 6–7)

"And you shall remember the Lord your God, for it is He who gives you the power to get wealth, that He may establish His covenant." — Deuteronomy 8:18

SERMON ONE

THE POWER TO GET WEALTH

A Kingdom Theology of Money

"And you shall remember the Lord your God, for it is He who gives you the power to get wealth, that He may establish His covenant which He swore to your fathers, as it is this day."

— Deuteronomy 8:18

I. INTRODUCTION — WAKING UP THE BODY OF CHRIST

The Church has for too long treated money as a secular matter. But God is not absent from the financial dimension of our lives. Billy Epperhart opens with a compelling declaration: 'It is time for the Body of Christ to wake up.' Christianity was never designed to stay inside the four walls of a church building. When we integrate our faith, our finances, and our work, we recognise that God has authority over every sphere of life.

Money is a tool — not a god, not an enemy. It can be leveraged to spread God's love in extraordinary ways. Yet many Christians are financially uninformed, carrying debt, and missing the opportunity to be stewards of Kingdom resources.

II. TWO DEFINITIONS OF FINANCIAL FREEDOM

Epperhart presents two complementary definitions of financial freedom that every believer should hold together:

- Definition 1 — Practical: The point at which passive income from investments exceeds your expenses. When this is achieved, you no longer work out of compulsion but out of calling.
- Definition 2 — Spiritual: An attitude of freedom from financial anxiety — rooted in the conviction that God is your Provider.

Jesus addressed both in Matthew 6:25-27. He did not say worry is a small problem. He knew that money anxiety is one of the primary ways people become enslaved — not just to poverty, but to the love of money through constant preoccupation with it.

III. GOD GIVES POWER, NOT JUST PROVISION

"God gives the power to get wealth — not the wealth itself." — Deuteronomy 8:18

Notice what the text does not say. It does not say God gives wealth. It says God gives the POWER to get it. The distinction is profound. God is not a divine ATM. He is a covenantal Father who equips His people with:

- Knowledge — understanding of principles
- Strategies — tested systems and methods
- Expertise — developed skill and wisdom
- Help — supernatural partnership

This means financial success in the Kingdom is not passive. It is a partnership. You bring the obedience; God brings the supernatural multiplication.

IV. THE MONEY-WORRY TRAP

Jesus knew that financial worry is itself a form of slavery. The person who thinks only wealthy people are in danger of loving money has missed the point. A person scraping by, consumed by financial anxiety, is also in bondage to money — it controls their thoughts, their decisions, their relationships, and their peace.

The Good News is that God has a better plan. His Road to Financial Freedom is not about accumulation for its own sake. It is about breaking the hold that money has on your life so you can be free to serve God fully.

V. THE PROMISE — 2 CORINTHIANS 9:8

"And God is able to make all grace abound toward you, that you, always having all sufficiency in all things, may have an abundance for every good work."

— 2 Corinthians 9:8

The goal is abundance for every good work — not abundance to hoard. God's purpose in blessing you is to make you a conduit of His grace to others. This will be the golden thread running through this entire sermon series.

VI. APPLICATION

APPLICATION / REFLECTION QUESTIONS

1. Where in your life does money function more as a master than a tool? Be honest.
2. What does it mean practically for you to 'remember the Lord your God' in your finances?
3. Do you believe God wants to be involved in the practical side of your financial life? What evidence from Scripture shapes your answer?
4. What would change in your family if you truly experienced financial freedom?

PRAYER POINTS

- *Lord, forgive me for every area where I have allowed money — whether poverty or anxiety — to master my thinking.*
- *Teach me to see money as a tool in Your hands for Kingdom advancement.*
- *Open my understanding to receive both the practical wisdom and spiritual power to get wealth.*

SERMON TWO

THE BIG PICTURE: THE TRIPLE-X FACTOR

Seeing the Whole Elephant

"Through wisdom a house is built, and by understanding it is established; by knowledge the rooms are filled with all precious and pleasant riches."

— Proverbs 24:3-4

I. THE PROBLEM WITH PARTIAL VISION

Most Christians who want to improve their finances receive partial, disconnected advice: get out of debt, save money, tithe, invest — but never in a coherent whole. Epperhart describes it this way: it is like standing inches from an elephant and describing only the trunk, or the tail, or the side. Each description is technically accurate, but none captures the whole.

God gave Epperhart what he calls a '30,000-foot view' of wealth — a comprehensive framework that connects every financial principle into one coherent journey. He calls this the Triple-X Factor.

II. THE TRIPLE-X FACTOR: THREE PHASES OF WEALTH

The Triple-X Factor maps the journey from indebtedness to generous wealth. It has three phases:

X1. THE FIRST X — INCOME EXCEEDS EXPENSES

This is where most people begin. First-X income is earned income — what you receive from an employer for your time and value. The First X is achieved when your income becomes greater than your expenses. This is not yet wealth; it is the launching pad for wealth.

Most households are not at the First X — they are spending more than they earn, serviced by consumer credit and debt.

X2. THE SECOND X — PASSIVE INCOME EXCEEDS EXPENSES

Second-X income is asset income — leveraged income that comes from investments: rent from property, dividends from stocks, profits from a business, royalties from creative work. This phase is also called financial freedom. You no longer need to work to survive; your assets work for you.

X3. THE THIRD X — WEALTH FOR KINGDOM IMPACT

Third-X income is abundance beyond personal need. At this level, a person can give away 100% of their reinvested passive income and portions of the assets themselves to Kingdom causes. This is not excess hoarded in bigger barns — it is prosperity with a purpose.

"Debt and wealth have a common denominator — both are related to how we handle money."

III. HOW INTEREST WORKS FOR YOU OR AGAINST YOU

The Triple-X Factor works by reversing the power of interest. When you are in debt, interest works against you — you pay more over time. When you are an investor, interest works for you — you gain more over time. The journey from the First X to the Third X is the journey from interest as your enemy to interest as your ally.

IV. WHERE WEALTH IS ACTUALLY BUILT

Wealth is not built through First-X income alone. In the First X, you trade time for money in a one-for-one exchange. Wealth is built in the Second X and Third X, where a one-time investment (a business, a property, a stock portfolio) pays out repeatedly without requiring more of your time.

This is why Paul could say, 'Not that I seek the gift, but I seek the fruit that abounds to your account' (Phil. 4:17). God is not against the increase — He designed it.

V. GOD GAVE ME THIS TOOL

Epperhart testifies that this framework came to him through prayer and years of seeking God about finances. The Triple-X Factor is not just financial strategy — it is a Spirit-given framework for stewardship. Deuteronomy 8:18 says God gives the power to get wealth; this is part of that power — wisdom revealed to those who ask.

VI. APPLICATION

APPLICATION / REFLECTION QUESTIONS

5. Which X are you currently in? Are you in debt (before the First X), at breakeven (the First X), or building assets (moving toward the Second X)?
6. What has been your '30,000-foot view' of money before this teaching? What gaps have you identified?
7. What would it mean for your church family, your community, or your ministry if you reached the Third X?
8. How does understanding the Triple-X Factor change the way you see tithing, saving, and investing?

PRAYER POINTS

- *Lord, give me a God-sized vision of my financial journey — not just today's crisis but the full picture.*
- *Break every partial, distorted mindset I have carried about money, debt, and wealth.*
- *I declare that interest will become my ally, not my enemy, in Jesus' name.*

SERMON THREE

FROM MANNA TO PROMISED LAND

Moving Beyond Survival Faith to Covenant Prosperity

"And they ate of the produce of the land on the day after the Passover... And the manna ceased on the day after they had eaten of the produce of the land. And there was no longer manna for the people of Israel."

— Joshua 5:11-12

I. DOES GOD WANT YOU TO BUILD WEALTH?

This is the foundational question many Christians are afraid to ask openly — because they are afraid of the answer, or afraid of what others will think. But it is a question the Bible answers directly. The issue is not whether God wants you blessed; He clearly does (Deuteronomy 28:2, 3 John 2). The deeper issue is this: what kind of blessing does God have in mind?

II. THE MANNA MINDSET

When God miraculously fed the Israelites in the wilderness with manna — bread from heaven that tasted like honey — it was a profound act of divine faithfulness. But Epperhart makes a critical observation: manna was not the fullness of God's plan. It was a stepping stone.

A manna mindset says: 'God, if You are real, prove it. Give me enough for today.' It is survival faith — always waiting for the next miracle, never building, never producing, never investing.

"A manna mindset is based in spiritual immaturity. We all start here. But we are called to grow beyond it."

The Israelites wandered for 40 years eating manna because God needed to 'get Egypt out of them' — the slave mentality, the scarcity thinking, the entitlement to provision without responsibility. Sound familiar?

III. THE PRODUCE OF THE LAND

Joshua 5:10-12 records one of the most significant financial transitions in biblical history. The moment the Israelites entered Canaan and ate the produce of the land, the manna stopped. Permanently.

This was not cruelty — it was graduation. They no longer needed daily miracles because they now lived in a land of perpetual fruitfulness. They had moved from consuming to producing. From dependency to stewardship. From Egypt's slave economy to Canaan's covenant economy.

IV. YOUR PROMISED LAND

God has a Promised Land for you — not a geographic location, but a season and dimension of Kingdom living where you are no longer just surviving but flourishing and blessing others.

The journey through the wilderness is real. There will be seasons of testing, waiting, and learning to trust. But the goal is always the Promised Land. And in the Promised Land, there is no manna — there is produce. There is building. There is inheritance.

- The manna is not the birthright — the land is the birthright.
- The manna is the appetiser — the land is the full inheritance.
- When Jesus said 'The Kingdom of Heaven is at hand' (Matt. 4:17), it meant our inheritance is activated now.

V. THE FINANCIAL PICTURE: WHERE YOU ARE AND WHERE YOU ARE HEADED

Epperhart challenges every believer to know their financial numbers honestly:

- What is your monthly income?
- What are your monthly expenses?
- What is the gap — positive or negative?

Most households spend more than they earn because consumer debt — credit cards, car loans, personal loans — makes it easy to live beyond your means. The average household carries debt exceeding their annual income. But awareness is the first step to change.

God is not surprised by your numbers. He knows them better than you do. And He has a plan to transform that picture — one covenant step at a time.

VI. FROM CONSUMER TO PRODUCER

The Promised Land transition is a shift from consumer to producer. A consumer takes; a producer creates and contributes. God calls His people to reflect His image as Creator-Provider. As we mature spiritually and financially, we move from being the recipient of God's daily provision to being the instrument of God's provision for others.

"Financial freedom equips Christians with the resources and time to fully dive into their Promised Land."

VII. APPLICATION

APPLICATION / REFLECTION QUESTIONS

9. Are you living with a manna mindset — expecting daily miracles but not building anything? What would it take to shift to a Promised Land mentality?
10. What 'Egypt' is still in you — what slave-economy thinking or scarcity mindsets do you need God to deliver you from?
11. Plot your finances honestly: income vs expenses. Where are you on the Triple-X chart?
12. What does your 'Promised Land' look like — what would you do with complete financial freedom?

PRAYER POINTS

- *Lord, deliver me from every manna mindset — every survival-only, miracle-dependent, never-building pattern of thinking.*
- *Lead me into my financial Promised Land. I choose to be a producer, not only a consumer.*
- *Reveal to me what 'Egypt' still has a hold on my financial decisions.*

SERMON FOUR

SEVEN STEPS TO FINANCIAL FREEDOM

A Roadmap Anyone Can Follow

"Any enterprise is built by wise planning, becomes strong through common sense, and profits wonderfully by keeping abreast of the facts."

— Proverbs 24:3-4 TLB

I. THE SEVEN-STEP FRAMEWORK

Epperhart distills the entire wealth-building journey into seven memorable steps. Each step corresponds to a phase of growth and builds on the one before it. No one is exempt from this process. Anyone can begin — and anyone can finish.

"No financial ruts allowed! Anyone is only ever seven steps away from financial freedom."

1. ESCALATE — INCREASE YOUR ABILITY TO EARN

Before you can change your financial picture, you must increase your value in the marketplace. Epperhart is emphatic: you do not get paid for time — you get paid for value. The more you grow in knowledge, skill, and wisdom, the more valuable you become.

- Read books, listen to podcasts, attend seminars
- Find mentors who have achieved what you are seeking
- Invest in yourself before you invest in anything else

'The more you learn, the more you earn.' This step is about escalating your human capital — the internal engine that drives external income.

2. ELIMINATE — REMOVE CONSUMER DEBT

Consumer debt is a wealth killer. Every rand or shilling paid in interest is money building someone else's wealth, not yours. Escalating your income means nothing if it is immediately swallowed by debt repayments. Eliminate consumer debt aggressively.

3. ACCUMULATE — BUILD AN EMERGENCY FUND AND SAVE FOR A HOME

Once income exceeds expenses, begin accumulating. First, build an emergency fund (3-6 months of living expenses). An unprepared emergency can undo years of financial progress. Second, save toward homeownership — owning a home is the cornerstone of asset-building for most people.

4. PARTICIPATE — ENTER THE ASSET-BUILDING GAME

Now begin to build an asset base through two low-risk starting points:

- Purchase your own home — your mortgage builds equity; renting builds nothing.
- Open a Roth IRA or equivalent investment account — tax-free growth over time is powerful.

Participation is the moment you shift from consumer to investor.

5. ACCELERATE — MULTIPLY WEALTH THROUGH THREE CHANNELS

There are three primary accelerators of wealth:

- Real estate investment — 90% of the world's millionaires have built wealth through property
- Stock market investment — requires patience and knowledge; do not rush in uninformed
- Your own business — a business can replace your First-X income entirely

Five forms of passive income to build: rent, business distributions, stock dividends, bond interest, royalties.

6. EMANCIPATE — BECOME FINANCIALLY FREE

Emancipation is the Second X. Your passive income now exceeds your expenses. You can choose whether or not to keep your job. This is not the end of work — it is the beginning of work done from calling rather than necessity.

Epperhart still works — not because he must, but because God has called him to. That is the difference emancipation makes.

7. DONATE — GIVE FROM THE THIRD X

The final step is the most glorious. With Third-X income, you can give away 100% of your excess income to the Kingdom. Social impact investing, church planting, microfinance for the poor, charitable causes — all become possible.

"You financially position yourself not just to enjoy wealth but to impact the Kingdom of God!"

II. THE INTERCONNECTED STAIRCASE

These seven steps are not isolated actions. They form a rising staircase. Each step creates the conditions for the next. You cannot skip steps — but you can accelerate them with intentionality, discipline, and partnership with God.

III. APPLICATION

APPLICATION / REFLECTION QUESTIONS

13. Which of the seven steps are you currently on? What is the most immediate next step for you?
14. What specific actions will you take this month to 'escalate' your value in the marketplace?
15. Who in your life models Step 6 or Step 7? How can you learn from them?
16. What would the 'donate' step look like for your family? What Kingdom causes would you fund?

PRAYER POINTS

- *Father, I receive the roadmap. Help me to be intentional, disciplined, and faithful in each step.*
- *I declare that I am escalating in wisdom and value, eliminating debt, and moving toward emancipation.*
- *Let everything I accumulate and build be for the advancement of Your Kingdom.*

SERMON FIVE

MASTERING YOUR EARNED INCOME

Four Pillars of First-X Excellence

"Do you see a man who excels in his work? He will stand before kings; he will not stand before unknown men."

— Proverbs 22:29

I. THE FIRST X IS YOUR LAUNCHING PAD

First-X income — earned income from employment or self-employment — is where most people's financial journey begins and, for many, where it stalls. The goal of the First X is not merely to earn more; it is to prepare the financial and personal foundation from which wealth can be built.

Epperhart identifies four key steps to mastering the First X. These are not just financial principles — they are personal development disciplines.

II. FOUR STEPS TO MASTER THE FIRST X

A. BECOME MORE VALUABLE

Jim Rohn observed: 'You are the average of the five people you spend the most time with.' Most people's wages fall within 20% of their friends' wages. The company you keep shapes the ceiling you accept.

But becoming more valuable is not merely social — it is spiritual. Jesus said, 'Be wise as serpents and innocent as doves' (Matthew 10:16). Wisdom from God's Word is the highest value multiplier.

Three practical investments:

- **LEARN** — Read, study, consume educational content. In ten years you can consume 1,000 books worth of wisdom.
- **LISTEN** — Find mentors. Ask successful people not just what they do, but what they think, believe, and envision. Get their 'recipe.'
- **LOOK** — Observe successful people carefully. Success always leaves clues. Model what works.

B. LEARN TO LIVE ON 80 PERCENT

The 80/20 principle is the financial foundation of discipline:

- 10% — Tithe: Give the first fruits to God. He is your Provider; tithing keeps this truth central.
- 70-80% — Necessary expenses: rent, food, bills, transport. Buy what you want within this envelope.
- 5-10% — Professional investment: Roth IRA, stocks, mutual funds. Let an investment bank work for you.
- 5-10% — Personal investment: learn to invest by doing — a small side business, a renovated item resold, a skill developed.

"Learn to live on 80% — and invest the rest with intentionality."

C. KNOW THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN ASSETS AND LIABILITIES

This distinction is foundational to all wealth building:

- A LIABILITY is something that costs you money and depreciates — a TV, a car, most consumer goods. They lose value the moment you buy them.
- An ASSET is something that puts money in your pocket — rental property, stocks, a business, royalties. Assets grow in value and pay you.

The goal is not to stop buying liabilities forever — it is to buy them from your asset income, not from your earned income or credit. When your investments pay for your lifestyle, you have arrived.

'There's nothing wrong with buying a sports car or a TV — but what if you bought it with cash from assets instead of buying it on credit?' (Epperhart)

D. ELIMINATE DEBT

Consumer debt is the biggest obstacle to First-X mastery. Epperhart illustrates it starkly: a \$2,000 TV bought on credit and paid by minimum payments can cost over \$10,000 by the time it is paid off — 31 years later. A \$275,000 mortgage can cost \$531,000 in total.

Debt does not just steal money — it steals time, peace, and freedom. Eliminating debt is not the end of the financial journey, but without it, no journey is possible.

III. NOBLE FAILURE — A WORD OF GRACE

Epperhart acknowledges that nobody makes wise financial decisions all the time — including himself. But when you fail, you do not label it as total failure; you call it 'noble failure' and extract the lesson. Every mistake navigated wisely becomes wisdom invested in your future.

"When you do fail, you call it noble failure instead of just plain failure, and you move forward."

IV. APPLICATION

APPLICATION / REFLECTION QUESTIONS

17. Who are the five people closest to you financially? Are they pulling you up or pulling you down?
18. Have you ever written a budget based on the 80/20 principle? What would change if you did?
19. List three things in your life you currently treat as assets but are actually liabilities. What would it look like to acquire a real asset this year?
20. What is your current relationship with consumer debt? What specific steps can you begin this week?

PRAYER POINTS

- *Lord, increase my value in the marketplace. Give me the wisdom, skill, and spiritual depth that makes me irreplaceable.*
- *I commit to stewardship — to live within my means, to tithe faithfully, and to invest intentionally.*
- *Break every agreement I have made with debt. I choose the path of freedom.*

SERMON SIX

NINE STEPS TO DESTROY DEBT

The Debt Snowball That Rolls Toward Freedom

"I will give you the treasures of darkness and hidden riches of secret places, that you may know that I, the Lord, who call you by your name, am the God of Israel."

— Isaiah 45:3

I. YOUR 'WHY' MUST BE STRONGER THAN YOUR DEBT

Getting out of debt requires more than a spreadsheet — it requires strong motivation. Epperhart opens this chapter by asking four critical questions every debt-elimination warrior must answer:

- Why do you want to be debt-free?
- What is the main thing keeping you in debt?
- What is your winning percentage (extra room in your budget)?
- How will freedom from debt impact your God-given dream?

Your 'why' is your fuel. Without it, the system will not sustain you through the hard months. Epperhart's own 'why' was a platform to change the world and to walk in God's blessings as a family. What is yours?

II. NINE STEPS TO GET OUT OF DEBT

- Step 1 — CUT UP OR FREEZE ALL BUT ONE CREDIT CARD. Destroy the tools of impulsive spending. (Do not cancel accounts — that harms your credit score. Simply stop using them.)
- Step 2 — PAY OFF CURRENT CHARGES EVERY MONTH. If you keep one card, pay it in full each month. If you cannot commit to this, switch to a debit card entirely. Stop adding new debt.
- Step 3 — MAKE MINIMUM PAYMENTS ON ALL DEBTS. Establish a rhythm of consistent, on-time payments across all debts. This is your foundation.
- Step 4 — LIST ALL YOUR DEBTS. Build a complete spreadsheet: debt name, balance, monthly minimum payment. Divide the minimum payment into the balance to calculate months to pay off each debt.
- Step 5 — ATTACK THE DEBT WITH THE SHORTEST PAYOFF FIRST. Counter-intuitive but powerful: do not start with the highest interest rate — start with the debt you can eliminate the fastest. Quick wins build momentum.
- Step 6 — DETERMINE YOUR WINNING PERCENTAGE. This is the 'secret sauce.' Your winning percentage is the amount left in your budget after all expenses are paid. Even 5-10% extra is powerful when applied aggressively.
- Step 7 — APPLY YOUR WINNING PERCENTAGE TO THE SHORTEST DEBT. Stack this extra money on top of the minimum payment for your target debt. You can often cut the repayment time in half.
- Step 8 — ONCE A DEBT IS PAID, ROLL ITS PAYMENT INTO THE NEXT DEBT. This is the snowball. When Debt 1 is gone, take what you were paying on it and add it to Debt 2's minimum. Your accelerated payment grows with every debt eliminated.

- Step 9 — APPLY YOUR GROWING WINNING PERCENTAGE TO ASSETS. When debt is gone, do not spend the freed-up money. Invest it. Turn your former debt payments into wealth builders.

"The numbers we used are real numbers. Using this method, I got completely out of debt — including my mortgage — in 84 months." — Billy Epperhart

III. THE SNOWBALL IN ACTION

Epperhart illustrates the snowball effect powerfully. Imagine you have four debts. When the first (smallest) debt is eliminated, you roll that monthly payment into the second debt. When the second is gone, you roll both payments into the third — and so on. Each month, your attack payment grows larger. What might take 15 years on minimum payments alone can be done in 5-7 years.

IV. DEBT ELIMINATION IS NOT THE FINISH LINE

Here is the danger zone many Christians enter: they get out of debt and then exhale — as if that was the final destination. Epperhart warns us that debt freedom is the starting line of wealth building, not the finish line.

The moment your debt payments are gone, you have a new winning percentage that can be redirected into assets. Do not celebrate by buying more liabilities. Celebrate by beginning the Second X.

"I will give you the treasures of darkness and hidden riches of secret places, that you may know that I, the Lord, who call you by your name, am the God of Israel."

— Isaiah 45:3

God has money out there with your name on it. The debt is not your destiny — the treasure is.

V. APPLICATION

APPLICATION / REFLECTION QUESTIONS

21. Write out your debt list right now: name, balance, minimum payment, months to pay off. Which debt gets attacked first?
22. What is your current winning percentage? If you have none, what expenses can you cut or what income can you add?
23. Share your debt elimination 'why' with a trusted accountability partner this week.
24. When your first debt is eliminated, what will you do with that freed-up money? Commit to it now.

PRAYER POINTS

- *Father, I declare freedom over my finances in the name of Jesus. I renounce every spirit of debt and financial bondage.*
- *Give me the discipline, creativity, and determination to execute this plan faithfully.*
- *I receive the hidden riches You have prepared for me — the treasures of darkness that are mine in covenant.*

SERMON SEVEN

WEALTHY AND WISE: BUILDING WEALTH AND GIVING IT AWAY

The Second and Third X — Investing for the Kingdom

"And you shall remember the Lord your God, for it is He who gives you the power to get wealth, that He may establish His covenant which He swore to your fathers, as it is this day."

— Deuteronomy 8:17-18

I. CROSSING THE LINE INTO SECOND-X FREEDOM

With perseverance and patience, the lines on your financial chart will eventually cross — income exceeds expenses. This is the First X. From there, investing the surplus aggressively into assets brings you to the Second X: passive income exceeds expenses. You are now financially free.

Second-X income (asset income) includes:

- Rent from investment property
- Dividends and capital gains from stocks
- Profits and distributions from a business
- Royalties from books, music, intellectual property
- Interest from bonds and fixed-income investments

These assets grow in value over time and continue paying you whether you work or not. This is the difference between a salary and wealth.

"Wealth building is fairly simple — it's just not easy. It takes energy, effort, and time."

II. SEVEN ATTITUDES REQUIRED TO BUILD THE SECOND X

Epperhart dedicates a significant section of Chapter 6 to the internal posture required for wealth building. Wrong attitudes will sabotage right strategies every time.

- 1. Accept Personal Responsibility — Stop blaming your background, your economy, or your government. You are the agent of change in your own life.
- 2. Take Personal Control — Refuse to be shaped by society's standards of debt and consumerism. Make counter-cultural decisions.
- 3. Expect the Best — Biblical hope is not wishful thinking; it is 'confidence in what we hope for' (Hebrews 11:1). Viktor Frankl survived a Nazi concentration camp through the power of positive imagination. What can you endure if you see your future clearly?
- 4. Be Creative — God is the ultimate Creator. You bear His image. There is always a way forward for those who partner with the Spirit.
- 5. Design Your Future — Write your goals with precision. Goals are targets; shotgun approaches hit nothing.
- 6. Take Action — 'Faith without works is dead' (James 2:26). Knowledge without action is just information. Half of accomplishing anything is taking the first step.

- 7. Adapt to Succeed — Change your methods when they are not producing results. The railroad companies that refused to see themselves as being in the transportation business were left behind. Don't be left behind.

III. HOVERING OVER THE WATERS — THE CREATIVE PROCESS

In Genesis 1:2, the Spirit of God hovered over the face of the waters before creation began. Epperhart applies this profoundly to wealth building: before you make a major investment decision, spend time hovering — praying, planning, thinking, listening to God. The Holy Spirit's brooding always precedes creative breakthrough.

Wealth building is not reckless. It is prayerful. Take inventory of your skills, your personality, your risk tolerance. Ask God to order your steps (Psalm 37:23). Then — take a step of faith. When your feet hit the water, it begins to part.

IV. THE THIRD X — WEALTHY AND WISE

Reaching the Third X is the culmination of the journey — and the beginning of its greatest season. At this level, passive income exceeds even a lavish lifestyle. The surplus is available to give away entirely. This is not accumulation for the self; this is prosperity with a Kingdom purpose.

"God's purpose for wealth is to make a difference." — Billy Epperhart

V. BIGGER BARNs OR BIGGER PURPOSE?

Jesus told the parable of the rich fool (Luke 12:16-20) as a warning against hoarding excess in bigger barns. The man had abundance but no Kingdom vision. He planned to eat, drink, and be merry — and died before he could.

The antidote to bigger barns is bigger purpose. Build barns, yes — but build them for the Kingdom's harvest. God wants you to have more than enough so that you can be more than enough for others.

Margaret Thatcher's famous observation about the Good Samaritan applies: nobody would remember the Good Samaritan if he only had good intentions. He had money — and he used it. That is Third-X living.

"Then a despised Samaritan came along, and when he saw the man, he felt compassion for him... The next day he handed the innkeeper two silver coins, telling him, 'Take care of this man. If his bill runs higher than this, I'll pay you the next time I'm here.'"

— Luke 10:33-35 NLT

VI. ESTABLISHING THE COVENANT

Deuteronomy 8:18 is not primarily a prosperity text. It is a covenant text. God gives the power to get wealth so that He may establish His covenant. The wealth is for the mission. The mission is to make God's glory known in all the earth.

Epperhart confesses that his early motivation for wealth was selfish. But God transformed him — showed him that financial freedom was the doorway to Kingdom assignment. That is the full circle: from slavery to sin, through wilderness testing, into Promised Land wealth, and finally into covenant partnership with God.

This is your story too. You are not building wealth for yourself. You are building it for the covenant.

"We are not about trying to build something to heap riches on ourselves; we are about advancing the Kingdom of God in the earth."

VII. APPLICATION

APPLICATION / REFLECTION QUESTIONS

25. Of the seven attitudes for building the Second X, which one do you most need to develop? What practical step will you take?
26. What is God currently calling you to 'hover' over — to pray and plan before taking action?
27. When you reach the Third X, what Kingdom causes will you fund? Write it down as a faith declaration.
28. How does the covenant purpose of Deuteronomy 8:18 change the way you view your financial ambitions?

PRAYER POINTS

- *Lord, align my attitudes with Your Kingdom economy. Where I have been passive, make me active. Where I have been fearful, give me holy boldness.*
- *I declare that my wealth will be a testimony to Your covenant faithfulness — not a monument to my own achievement.*
- *Use me as a Good Samaritan in my generation — with the resources, the compassion, and the wisdom to make a lasting difference.*
- *I receive the power to get wealth. I receive it for the covenant. I receive it for the Kingdom. In Jesus' name.*

END OF SERIES

FPPK Kericho Town Church | God's Road to Financial Freedom Sermon Series